

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

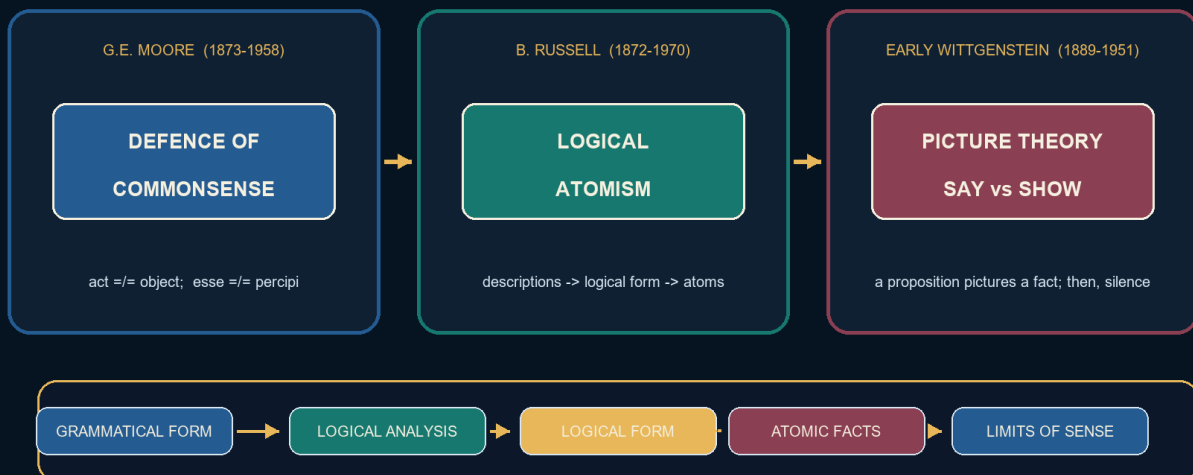
MOORE, RUSSELL & EARLY WITTGENSTEIN - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper I Western Philosophy 06

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

PHILOSOPHY PAPER I | WESTERN PHILOSOPHY 06

MOORE RUSSELL EARLY WITTGENSTEIN

The analytic revolt against idealism: from commonsense, through logical form, to the limits of sense.



Reveal the logical form hidden by grammar | say the facts, show the form | Tractatus 7: whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Western Philosophy Paper I bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 14 clause-owned questions, at least one in every year (joint-highest in the Western section).
- The 2018 Q3(a) Berkeley/Moore/Russell comparison is primary-owned by Empiricism; it is used only as a labelled cross-link and never counted among the 14. Later Wittgenstein parts (private language, family resemblance, use-theory, forms of life) are owned by the Later Wittgenstein clause and kept separate.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: claim -> named text/quotation -> analysis -> objection/reply -> verdict.
- MCQs: 32 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 40, strict A-B-C-D rotation ten times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Contemporary linkage is not forced: no verified 2026 news anchor exists, so none is invented; the standing relevance is the clause's permanent place in the philosophy of language.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

Practice Design

The workbook sequence is exact verified PYQs -> 32 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus block in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED TEXT/EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION/REPLY -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 14 VERIFIED CLAUSE-OWNED QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the continuous local Western Philosophy Paper I bank for 2018-2025. Moore-Russell-Early Wittgenstein owns exactly 14 primary parts (joint-highest), at least one in every year. The 2018 Q3(a) Berkeley/Moore/Russell comparison is primary-owned by Empiricism and is used only as a labelled cross-link, never counted here. Later Wittgenstein parts (private language, family resemblance, use-theory, forms of life) are kept strictly separate even when they discuss the transition from the Tractatus.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: How does Wittgenstein apply the distinction between 'saying' and 'showing' to point to a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy? Is he justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Model solution

Directive - "how does he apply... is he justified?": expound the application, then deliver a reasoned verdict.

Thesis. The saying/showing distinction gives Wittgenstein a *single* meta-philosophical method: the "most decisive problems" of philosophy are not solved but **dissolved**, because they are attempts to *say* what can only be *shown*. He is largely justified as diagnosis, though the method is self-undermining.

The distinction. To say is to assert a senseful factual proposition that pictures a contingent state of affairs (bipolar - capable of truth *and* falsity). What can only be *shown* includes the **logical form** language shares with the world, and the **ethical, aesthetic and mystical**.

The single way. Metaphysics, the self, the meaning of life and value all try to state what lies outside the picturable world; each is therefore *unsinnig* (nonsense), not false. The one correct method is, for every such problem, to exhibit that its sentences transgress the limits of sense - so the problem lapses. Logic, ethics and metaphysics are handled by one criterion.

Named text. Proposition 7: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent." The ladder (6.54): the Tractatus's own propositions are nonsense to be climbed and then thrown away.

Is he justified? (reasons).

- *For*: the distinction unifies logic and value under a single account of sense, genuinely deflates pseudo-problems, and anticipates later verificationism.
- *Against*: the **self-referential paradox** - if the Tractatus is nonsense, how does it instruct? Russell objected that Wittgenstein "manages to say a good deal about what cannot be said." The **resolute** reading treats the sentences as therapeutic nonsense; the **standard** reading as illuminating nonsense that gestures at what shows itself. The underlying picture theory also faces the colour-exclusion problem.

Verdict. Justified as a diagnostic that relocates the decisive problems to the domain of showing; only partly justified as doctrine, since its self-application is paradoxical and is better read as *marking* the boundary than stating a further truth.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q4(c), 15 marks

Question: How is Russell's theory of definite description related to his Logical Atomism? Discuss and give reasons for your answer.

Model solution

Directive - "how related... discuss and give reasons": exhibit the internal link, not two separate topics.

Thesis. The theory of definite descriptions is the **engine** of Logical Atomism: it shows how apparent referring expressions dissolve into quantificational structure, which licenses analysis down to genuine simples - the atoms.

Descriptions (the method). "The F is G" analyses as $(Ex)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Gx]$. "The present King of France is bald" is therefore **false, not meaningless**; "the F" is an **incomplete symbol** with no meaning in isolation that *disappears* on analysis.

Three links to atomism.

1. **Grammatical vs logical form.** Descriptions prove that surface grammar hides logical form; atomism is the thesis that this analysis *terminates* in atomic propositions picturing atomic facts.
2. **Incomplete symbols -> constructions.** The same device dissolves classes, numbers and material objects into **logical constructions**: "Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities." What survives analysis are atoms (logically proper names) and universals.
3. **Ontological economy.** Descriptions banish Meinong's non-existent objects; atomism keeps only what analysis certifies. **Isomorphism** then pairs each atomic proposition with an atomic fact.

Named text. "On Denoting" (1905); the atoms are "logical atoms and not physical atoms" - the *last residue in analysis*, of which descriptions is the exemplar.

Objection/reply. Strawson (1950) charges that descriptions misdescribe ordinary use (presupposition, not assertion). Reply: even granting this about conversation, the *analytical* discovery - that meaning has hidden logical structure terminating in simples - is exactly what atomism needs.

Verdict. Descriptions supply the paradigm of analysis that atomism generalises; the two are one programme - method (descriptions) and its metaphysical terminus (atoms).

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: Why is Moore's philosophy called common-sense realism?

Model solution

Directive - "why is it called...": justify the label on both counts, common sense *and* realism.

Thesis. Moore's philosophy is "common-sense realism" because he holds that certain commonsense **truisms** about a **mind-independent** world are known with certainty, and that philosophy must answer to them rather than overturn them.

The "common-sense" half. In "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) Moore lists **truisms** - I have a body, the earth existed for many years before my birth, there are other people - each "known to be true with certainty." Crucially, **knowing is not analysing**: we know a truism is true even when we cannot give its correct analysis (the paradox of analysis). Certainty attaches to the truism, not to any philosopher's theory of it.

The "realism" half. The world these truisms describe is **mind-independent**. This is reinforced by the **Refutation of Idealism** (act/object distinction defeats *esse est percipi*) and the **Proof of an External World** (1939): "Here is one hand... and here is another" is offered as a rigorous proof that external things exist.

Method / burden reversal. Philosophy defends common sense; when a sceptical or idealist argument conflicts with a truism, its premises are *less* certain than "here is one hand," so it is the argument that must be rejected.

Objection/reply. The sceptic charges question-begging. Reply: Moore reverses the **burden of proof** rather than refuting doubt head-on; Wittgenstein's *On Certainty* later refines this - truisms are **hinges** on which doubt itself turns and so cannot themselves be doubted.

Verdict. "Common-sense realism" is apt: it names Moore's **epistemology** (commonsense certainties) and his **ontology** (mind-independent realism) together, even if its anti-sceptical force remains contested.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2020 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: Critically discuss the following statement by Moore: "If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same thing as to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he makes a mistake and a self-contradictory mistake."

Model solution

Directive - "critically discuss": expound the point, then weigh it.

Thesis. The remark distils Moore's **Refutation of Idealism**: to identify "Blue exists" with "Both blue and consciousness exist" is to conflate the **object** of awareness with the **act** of awareness, and that identification is self-contradictory because the two propositions have different content.

Context. The target is Berkeley's *esse est percipi*. Idealism treats a sensation as an undifferentiated unity; Moore analyses every sensation into two elements - the **act** (consciousness, the *same* in the sensation of blue and of green) and the **object** (the blue, the green, which *differ*).

The quoted claim. "Blue exists" asserts the object; "blue and consciousness exist" asserts object *plus* act. To call these the *same* proposition is to smuggle consciousness into the very content of "blue." Since they plainly assert different things, the identification is a "self-contradictory mistake."

Diaphanous thesis. Consciousness is **transparent** - we look straight through it to the blue and overlook the act; that transparency is *why* the idealist fuses object with act and arrives at *esse est percipi*.

Result. Object $\neq$ act; the object can therefore exist unperceived; *esse* $\neq$ *percipi*.

Critical assessment.

- The **diaphanous** thesis is also Moore's soft spot: if awareness is never directly caught, the act/object distinction is *asserted* rather than *exhibited*.
- **Limits:** the argument refutes *one* argument for idealism, not realism directly, and does **not** touch Hegel's Absolute Idealism.
- The **sense-datum** legacy (object as a given item) later collapses under Sellars' "Myth of the Given."

Verdict. Moore's charge of self-contradiction lands squarely on the *identification*; the negative result is secure even though the positive sense-datum doctrine it inspired proved unstable.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: "The reason that I call my doctrine logical atomism is because the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms." Write a note on the nature of atomic facts according to Russell in the light of the above statement.

Model solution

Directive - "write a note... in the light of the statement": anchor everything on the quotation.

Thesis. For Russell, atomic facts are the simplest constituents of reality; they are **logical** atoms - the last residue of **analysis** - and emphatically **not physical** atoms.

The quotation. "The atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms." So "atomic" marks **logical simplicity and independence**, reached by analysing propositions, not microscopic size discovered by physics.

Nature of atomic facts.

- An **atomic fact** is a simple particular having a quality or standing in a relation - e.g., "this is red." It is what corresponds to a true **atomic proposition** (a logically proper name, or names, plus a predicate).
- **Atomic vs molecular:** molecular propositions ("p and q," "p or q") are **truth-functions** of atomic ones; the connectives name nothing - there is no "and"-fact in the world.
- **Isomorphism:** a true atomic proposition shares the structure of its fact - names correspond to objects, and the *arrangement* of names to the *arrangement* of objects.

Logical, not physical (developed). The atoms are Russell's **sense-data and universals**, identified by acquaintance - an **epistemological** base. This contrasts with the *Tractatus*'s "objects," which are logical simples whose nature is left unspecified.

Objection/reply. The sense-datum base is empirically vulnerable (Sellars). Reply: whatever the ultimate simples turn out to be, the *logical* point stands - meaning and truth bottom out in atomic propositions picturing atomic facts.

Verdict. Atomic facts are the ontological correlates that analysis *requires*; the quoted sentence exists precisely to forbid mistaking them for tiny physical particles.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2021 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: What are the main arguments put forward by Moore in his paper "A Defence of Common Sense" to prove that there are possible propositions about the world that are known to be true with certainty? Do you think Moore's arguments provide a sufficient response to objections presented by the sceptic against the possibility of knowledge? Give reasons in support of your answer.

Model solution

Directive - "what are the arguments... do you think they are sufficient?": expound, then judge against the sceptic.

Thesis. In "A Defence of Common Sense," Moore argues that a class of commonsense **truisms** is known to be true with certainty; his answer to scepticism is a **burden-reversal** that is dialectically compelling but, against the radical sceptic, not demonstratively sufficient.

Moore's arguments.

1. **The list of truisms** (1925): "I have a body," "the earth existed for years before my birth," "there are other human beings" - each known *with certainty*.
2. **Knowing vs analysing:** we *know* these are true even though we cannot state their correct **analysis** (the paradox of analysis); certainty does not wait on analysis.
3. **Self-refutation of the sceptic:** the philosopher who asserts "there are no other people" presupposes an audience and a shared language.
4. **Certainty comparison / burden reversal:** no premise of a sceptical argument is *more* certain than "here is one hand." Developed in the **Proof of an External World** (1939): "Here is one hand... and here is another" is a proof whose premises are known, differ from the conclusion, and entail it (Moore's three conditions).

Is it sufficient? (reasons on both sides).

- *For*: it relocates certainty to where it actually lies and shifts the **burden** onto the sceptic; Wittgenstein's *On Certainty* vindicates the strategy - the truisms are **hinges** on which doubt turns and so cannot themselves be doubted.
- *Against*: Moore never *proves* he is not dreaming; against a sceptic who challenges the very **entitlement** to the premises, "here is one hand" **begs the question**; the proof assumes what is at issue.

Verdict. Against the *dogmatic* sceptic Moore's burden-reversal is sufficient and is deepened by the hinge diagnosis; against the *radical* sceptic it is a powerful dialectical stance rather than a demonstrative refutation.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q4(c), 15 marks

Question: What does Wittgenstein mean by the statement — "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent?" Critically discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "what does he mean... critically discuss": gloss proposition 7, then weigh it.

Thesis. Proposition 7 draws the **limit of language from within**: only factual, picturing propositions can be *said*; logical form, ethics, aesthetics and the mystical can at most be *shown*, so of them "one must be silent."

Meaning in context. The Tractatus fixes the limits of sense through **bipolarity** (a genuine proposition must be able to be true *and* false). Two limiting cases carry no factual content - tautology and contradiction are **sinnlos** (senseless but well-formed); attempts to state what lies beyond the picturable world are **unsinnig** (nonsense).

What falls on the silent side.

- **Logical form** - shown by propositions, never stated by them.
- **Ethics and aesthetics** - transcendental; "there can be no ethical propositions."
- **The mystical** - "not *how* the world is... but *that* it is."
- **The metaphysical self** - a limit of the world, not an object in it.

Named text. Proposition 7 - Ogden: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent"; Pears-McGuinness: "What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence." Ladder (6.54): the Tractatus's own sentences are nonsense to be discarded once they have done their work.

Critical assessment. The doctrine is a precise consequence of the picture theory, not mysticism-for-its-own-sake. But it faces the **self-referential paradox**: if 7 itself cannot be said, the book saws off the branch it sits on. Readings diverge - **resolute** (plain therapeutic nonsense) vs **standard** (illuminating nonsense); Russell worried Wittgenstein says much about the unsayable.

Verdict. Proposition 7 is the disciplined terminus of the picture theory; its paradox is genuine and is best read as *marking* the boundary of sense rather than asserting a further fact beyond it.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2022 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: What is Bertrand Russell's method of logical analysis? How does it ultimately end in establishing atomic theory of meaning? Discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "what is the method... how does it end in atomic theory of meaning": connect method to terminus.

Thesis. Russell's method of **logical analysis** replaces misleading grammatical form with real logical form; pursued to its end, analysis terminates in **atomic propositions** whose meaning is their picturing of **atomic facts** - an atomic theory of meaning.

The method. Surface grammar deceives: "the present King of France" *looks* like a name but is an **incomplete symbol**. Analysis (the **theory of descriptions** is the exemplar) rewrites such sentences to expose their quantificational logical form, and **logical constructions** replace inferred entities ("substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities").

How it ends in atomism. Each analysis removes an apparent constituent until nothing further can be decomposed. What remains are **simples** - logically proper names for acquaintance-objects (sense-data) plus universals. Meaning

bottoms out exactly here: an **atomic proposition** means the **atomic fact** it pictures (isomorphism of names/objects and arrangement/arrangement), and every molecular proposition is a **truth-function** of atomic ones.

Named text. The atoms are "logical atoms and not physical atoms" - the last residue of analysis.

Assessment. The acquaintance base is contestable (Sellars), but the structural claim is robust: analysis fixes meaning by grounding it in the simplest picturing propositions.

Verdict. Analysis is the method and atomism its terminus; the theory of meaning is atomic because significance is anchored in atomic propositions depicting atomic facts.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2022 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: Is there any difference between pictorial form and logical form in Ludwig Wittgenstein's picture theory of language? How does the logical form define the relation between language and reality? Explain.

Model solution

Directive - "is there any difference... how does logical form relate language and reality": distinguish the two forms, then use logical form as the bridge.

Thesis. Yes - **pictorial form** is what lets a picture depict *at all*, whereas **logical form** is the form shared by *every* picture and by reality; logical form is precisely the shared structure that connects language to the world.

Ontology first. "The world is the totality of facts, not of things" (1.1); states of affairs are **objects** in combination. A proposition is a **picture** of a possible situation: names go proxy for objects, and the **arrangement** of names mirrors the arrangement of objects.

Pictorial form. The possibility that the picture's elements are combined as the things are. It varies with the medium - a spatial picture has spatial form, a coloured one colour form, a musical score its own form.

Logical form. The **pictorial form common to all pictures whatever** - the form a picture and reality *must* share to be able to depict truly or falsely. A picture can depict any pictorial form, but it **cannot depict its own logical form**: logical form is **shown, not said**.

The difference. Pictorial form is the species (medium-specific); logical form is the universal genus - the minimal structure any representation must share with what it represents.

How logical form relates language and reality. A proposition connects to the world by **sharing logical form** with the fact it represents; because it pictures a mere *possibility*, it can **agree or disagree** with reality - truth or falsity, hence **bipolarity**. This picturing is **logical, not psychological**: a proposition is not a mental image.

Verdict. There is a real difference - species vs the universal genus - and it is **logical form**, the isomorphism between sentence and fact, that makes representation and therefore the whole language-world relation possible.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2023 Q4(b), 15 marks

Question: Why according to Russell is the proposition — "The present king of France is bald" problematic? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "why problematic... critically discuss": state the puzzle, give the analysis, then weigh a rival.

Thesis. The sentence is problematic because it is **meaningful yet lacks a referent**; Russell dissolves the problem by analysing the description into **existence + uniqueness + predication**, which makes the sentence **false, not meaningless**, with no dubious object.

The puzzle. Grammatically "The present King of France is bald" is subject-predicate, so it *seems* to require a King to be *about*; yet there is none. Rivals pay a price: **Meinong** posits a subsisting non-existent King (ontological extravagance); on a Fregean line the sentence lacks a truth-value.

Russell's analysis. $(\exists x)[Kx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Ky \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Bx]$ - "there is exactly one present King of France and he is bald." The **existence** clause is false, so the whole conjunction is **FALSE**. "The present King of France" is an **incomplete symbol**: no meaning in isolation, it *disappears* on analysis, so nothing need be denoted.

Payoff - three puzzles solved. Negative existentials ("the KoF does not exist" is coherent); **excluded middle** via **scope** (on the *secondary/narrow* occurrence "it is not the case that there is exactly one bald KoF" is **true**); identity/substitutivity (the description is quantificational, not referential).

Critical - the rival. Strawson ("On Referring," 1950): the sentence is **neither true nor false**; *using* "the present King of France" carries a **presupposition** of existence that here fails, so the question of truth-value does not arise. This is a genuine rival about *ordinary language*, but it does not overturn the *logic* of Russell's analysis, which was never a theory of conversation.

Verdict. Russell makes the sentence false and referent-free without Meinongian objects; the enduring lesson is **grammatical form $\neq$ logical form**, though Strawson's presupposition account remains a live alternative about ordinary use.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q1(c), 10 marks

Question: What arguments are offered by Moore to prove that there are certain truisms, knowledge of which is a matter of common sense? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "what arguments... critically discuss": list the arguments, then weigh them.

Thesis. Moore argues that a set of **truisms** is known to be true with certainty **as a matter of common sense**, and that their certainty outweighs any philosophical premise brought against them.

The arguments.

1. **The truisms themselves** ("A Defence of Common Sense," 1925): "I have a body," "the earth existed for many years," "there are other people" - each "known to be true with certainty."
2. **Knowing vs analysing:** we *know* a truism even when we cannot give its correct **analysis**; certainty does not depend on solving the paradox of analysis.
3. **Self-refutation of denial:** to assert "there are no other people" is pragmatically self-defeating, presupposing an audience and language.
4. **Burden reversal:** no premise of a sceptical argument is *more* certain than the truism it would deny.

Critical assessment. The sceptic replies that Moore **begs the question** - he relocates certainty rather than defeating radical doubt. Yet Wittgenstein's *On Certainty* strengthens Moore: the truisms function as **hinges** on which the practice of doubt itself turns, so they are not the sort of thing that *can* be doubted.

Verdict. Moore secures the truisms **dialectically** by burden-reversal; the case is compelling against dogmatic scepticism and, via the hinge diagnosis, resilient - though against the radical sceptic it persuades rather than demonstrates.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Explain Russell's notion of incomplete symbols. Also explain how this notion leads to the doctrine of logical atomism.

Model solution

Directive - "explain... also explain how it leads to atomism": define, then trace the road to atomism.

Thesis. An **incomplete symbol** has no meaning in isolation and *disappears* on analysis; generalising this device - descriptions, then constructions - drives analysis down to genuine simples, and that terminus is **Logical Atomism**.

Incomplete symbols defined. A symbol that means nothing on its own and contributes only in the context of a whole proposition; the **test** is that it vanishes when the sentence is rewritten. The paradigm is the **definite description** ("On Denoting," 1905): $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Fy \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Gx]$. "The present King of France is bald" is thus **false, not meaningless**, and posits no Meinongian object.

Generalisation to constructions. Classes, numbers and material objects are likewise incomplete symbols / **logical constructions**: "Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities" (the supreme maxim; Occam's razor). A material object becomes an orderly **system of sense-data**, not an inferred hidden thing.

The road to atomism. Each analysis removes an apparent entity; the process terminates in **atomic propositions** - logically proper names for acquaintance-objects plus universals - that **picture atomic facts**. "The atoms... are logical atoms and not physical atoms." Isomorphism pairs atomic proposition with atomic fact; molecular propositions are **truth-functions**.

Assessment. The sense-datum base is vulnerable (Sellars); private data raise the **solipsism/other-minds** worry; Strawson contests the descriptions analysis; some inferences resist construction, so the maxim is a **regulative ideal**. Even so, the structural thesis - meaning and ontology bottom out in analysed simples - is exactly atomism.

Verdict. Incomplete symbols are the analytic **lever**; applied across the board they yield the sparse, structured world of logical atomism - a metaphysics generated by a method.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: "The golden mountain is very high." Discuss this statement in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions.

Model solution

Directive - "discuss this statement in the context of the theory of descriptions": apply the analysis to the example.

Thesis. "The golden mountain is very high" is handled by the **theory of descriptions**: analysed into **existence + uniqueness + predication**, its existence clause fails, so the sentence is **false** - and no golden mountain need "subsist."

The problem. The phrase "the golden mountain" denotes nothing, yet the sentence is perfectly meaningful. **Meinong** would grant the golden mountain a shadowy "being"; Russell rejects such ontological extravagance.

The analysis. $(Ex)[(Gx \ \& \ Mx) \ \& \ (Ay)((Gy \ \& \ My) \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Hx]$ - "there is exactly one thing that is golden and a mountain, and it is very high." Because **nothing** is both golden and a mountain, the **existence** clause is false, so the whole sentence is **FALSE**. "The golden mountain" is an **incomplete symbol**: no meaning in isolation, it *disappears* on analysis, carrying **no** ontological commitment.

Payoff. The example shows **grammatical form $\neq$ logical form** and secures **ontological economy** - significance without Meinongian objects.

Verdict. The sentence is significant but **false**; the theory of descriptions dissolves the pseudo-entity, exhibiting Russell's analytic method in miniature.

Solved PYQ 14 - 2025 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either." Present an account of Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement.

Model solution

Directive - "present an account... with reference to this statement": keep the quoted sentence at the centre.

Thesis. The quoted sentence is the crux of Moore's **Refutation of Idealism**: by distinguishing the **object** of sensation (blue, green) from the **consciousness** common to both, Moore separates what idealism runs together and so refutes *esse est percipi*.

Target. Berkeley's *esse est percipi* and, generally, idealism's claim that reality is mind-dependent.

The argument. Every sensation has two elements: the **act** (consciousness, the *same* in the sensation of blue and of green) and the **object** (the blue, the green, which *differ*). The quoted sentence states exactly this: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either."

Diaphanous thesis. Consciousness is **transparent** - we look straight through it to the blue and overlook the act. That transparency explains *why* the idealist fuses object with act and concludes *esse est percipi*.

Result. Object $\neq$ act; therefore the object can exist **unperceived**; *esse $\neq$ percipi*.

Critical assessment. The **diaphanous** thesis is also the weak point: if awareness is never caught directly, the act/object distinction is *asserted* rather than *exhibited*. **Limits:** the argument refutes *one* argument for idealism, not realism directly, and does **not** touch Hegel's Absolute Idealism; the **sense-datum** legacy later collapses under Sellars.

Verdict. With reference to this statement, Moore's separation of object from act defeats *esse est percipi*; the negative refutation succeeds even though the positive sense-datum theory it inspired does not.

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 40 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-32 are core coverage across all ten subtopics; Questions 33-40 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D ten times.

MCQ 1

The analytic revolt led by Moore and Russell was, in the first instance, a reaction against which movement?

- A. British Absolute (Hegelian-Bradleyan) Idealism B. The logical positivism of the Vienna Circle C. American pragmatism D. Cartesian rationalism

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Moore and Russell were idealists first and revolted against Bradley's Absolute Idealism; their shared weapon was the logical analysis of language.

MCQ 2

What method most clearly unites Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein?

- A. The transcendental deduction of the categories B. Logical analysis that reveals logical form behind grammatical form C. Dialectical synthesis of thesis and antithesis D. Phenomenological bracketing of the natural attitude

Correct answer: B

Explanation: All three practise analysis of language or propositions to expose the logical form that surface grammar conceals.

MCQ 3

Which statement about the ownership of 'Logical Atomism' is correct?

- A. It is owned solely by the Tractatus B. It is owned solely by Russell C. It is co-owned by Russell (1918) and the Tractatus, though the two versions differ D. It is a doctrine internal to Moore's common-sense realism

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Atomism is co-owned: Russell's atoms are sense-data and universals (epistemic), while the Tractatus's objects are logical simples left unexemplified.

MCQ 4

In 'A Defence of Common Sense', which distinction does Moore rely on to hold that a truism can be certain even if philosophers dispute its correct account?

- A. Sense versus reference B. Analytic versus synthetic C. Saying versus showing D. Knowing a proposition versus analysing it

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Moore insists we know truisms with certainty even when we cannot give their correct analysis - the point behind the paradox of analysis.

MCQ 5

Moore's 'Proof of an External World' (1939) famously turns on which gesture?

- A. Holding up his hands: 'Here is one hand... and here is another' B. Declaring 'The world is all that is the case' C. Asserting 'esse est percipi' D. Concluding 'Whereof one cannot speak...'

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Moore treats the existence of his two hands as a rigorous proof whose premises are known, differ from the conclusion, and entail it.

MCQ 6

How is Moore's reply to the sceptic best characterised?

- A. A transcendental argument from the conditions of possible experience B. A reversal of the burden of proof: the truism is more certain than any premise the sceptic can offer C. A verificationist criterion of meaning D. An appeal to a divine guarantee of our faculties

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Moore relocates certainty and shifts the burden; Wittgenstein's *On Certainty* later refines this with the 'hinge' diagnosis.

MCQ 7

The 'paradox of analysis' is the difficulty that:

- A. every analysis is viciously circular B. analysis always destroys the meaning of the analysandum C. if an analysis is correct it seems trivial, yet if it is informative it seems incorrect D. no proposition can ever be analysed into atomic facts

Correct answer: C

Explanation: A correct analysis looks like a trivial identity, yet a genuinely useful analysis is informative - hence the puzzle Moore highlights.

MCQ 8

The specific target of Moore's 'Refutation of Idealism' is the thesis:

- A. the Real is the Rational (Hegel) B. cogito ergo sum (Descartes) C. the world is the totality of facts (Wittgenstein) D. esse est percipi (Berkeley)

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Moore attacks the Berkeleyan identification of being with being-perceived; he explicitly does not touch Hegel's Absolute Idealism.

MCQ 9

The central distinction Moore draws inside every sensation is between:

- A. the act of awareness (common to all sensations) and the object of awareness (which varies) B. sense and reference C. primary and secondary qualities D. analytic and synthetic judgments

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Consciousness is the same in the sensation of blue and of green; the objects (blue, green) differ - so act and object are distinct.

MCQ 10

Moore describes consciousness as 'diaphanous' in order to say that:

A. consciousness is always coloured by its objects B. awareness is transparent, so we look through it and tend to overlook it C. consciousness cannot exist without a body D. the act and the object are ultimately identical

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Transparency explains why idealists overlook the act and fuse it with the object; it is also, notoriously, Moore's own weak point.

MCQ 11

When Russell insists his atoms are 'logical atoms and not physical atoms', he means that they are:

A. the smallest particles recognised by physics B. mental images in the mind of the knower C. the last residue of logical analysis, not microscopic entities D. Kantian noumena beyond all experience

Correct answer: C

Explanation: 'Atomic' marks logical simplicity and independence reached by analysing propositions, not physical smallness.

MCQ 12

In Russell's atomism, molecular propositions are:

A. names of complex physical objects B. atomic facts in disguise C. incomplete symbols D. truth-functions of atomic propositions, the connectives naming nothing

Correct answer: D

Explanation: There is no 'and'-fact in the world; the truth of a molecular proposition is fixed by its atomic parts plus the connectives.

MCQ 13

The isomorphism thesis holds that a true atomic proposition:

A. shares the structure of its fact - names correspond to objects and arrangement to arrangement B. is identical with a mental picture in the speaker C. is a tautology of logic D. denotes a Meinongian subsisting object

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Russell's bridge between language and world is a structural mirroring of names/objects and their arrangements.

MCQ 14

For Russell, the phrase 'the present King of France' is:

A. a logically proper name B. an incomplete symbol with no meaning in isolation C. a rigid designator D. the name of a universal

Correct answer: B

Explanation: It contributes only inside a whole sentence and disappears when the sentence is analysed into quantifiers.

MCQ 15

On Russell's analysis, 'The present King of France is bald' is:

A. meaningless B. neither true nor false C. false, because the existence clause fails D. true, but only vacuously

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Analysed as $(\exists x)[Kx \ \& \ (Ay)(Ky \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Bx]$, the existence clause is false, so the whole conjunction is false - not meaningless.

MCQ 16

Russell analyses 'the F is G' into which three components?

A. sense, reference and tone B. quality, relation and substance C. subject, copula and predicate D. existence, uniqueness and predication

Correct answer: D

Explanation: There is at least one F, at most one F, and it is G - the trio that dissolves the definite description.

MCQ 17

The apparent conflict over whether 'The King of France is not bald' is true or false is resolved by:

A. the scope distinction - primary (wide) versus secondary (narrow) occurrence of the description B. abandoning the law of excluded middle C. positing a subsisting King of France D. treating 'bald' as hopelessly vague

Correct answer: A

Explanation: On the narrow-scope reading the negation denies the whole existential claim and is true; no logical law is violated.

MCQ 18

Strawson's objection to Russell's theory of descriptions is that such sentences:

A. are always true B. carry a presupposition of existence, so when it fails the sentence is neither true nor false C. denote Meinongian objects after all D. are disguised tautologies

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Strawson targets ordinary use; it is a rival account of reference, not a refutation of the logic of Russell's analysis.

MCQ 19

Russell's Principle of Acquaintance states that:

A. all knowledge is ultimately by description B. every object is a logical construction C. every proposition we can understand is composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted D. ordinary names are rigid designators

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Acquaintance is the foundation on which knowledge by description rests - understanding requires acquaintance with the constituents.

MCQ 20

In Russell's Bismarck example, those of us who never met Bismarck know him:

A. by acquaintance with his very sense-data B. through a logically proper name C. not at all D. purely by description, as 'the first Chancellor of the German Empire'

Correct answer: D

Explanation: As the object recedes, knowledge is carried increasingly by description rather than acquaintance.

MCQ 21

For Russell, ordinary proper names such as 'Bismarck' or 'Socrates' are:

- A. disguised definite descriptions B. logically proper names guaranteed a referent C. incomplete symbols admitting no analysis D. names of universals

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Only 'this' and 'that' for present sense-data are logically proper names; ordinary names abbreviate descriptions.

MCQ 22

Russell's 'supreme maxim of scientific philosophising' is:

- A. entities must not be multiplied, so all constructions must be denied B. wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities C. the limits of my language are the limits of my world D. whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The maxim recommends building objects from the known (sense-data) rather than inferring hidden entities we might be wrong about.

MCQ 23

A Russellian 'logical construction' such as a material object is best described as:

- A. an inferred entity lying behind the appearances B. a Meinongian subsisting object C. an orderly system of sense-data, expressed by an incomplete symbol D. a physical atom

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Constructions are voiced by incomplete symbols - the same analytic device as definite descriptions.

MCQ 24

The opening ontology of the Tractatus asserts that:

- A. the world is the totality of things B. the world is my idea C. the world is the Absolute realising itself D. the world is the totality of facts, not of things

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Tractatus 1.1 - the world is facts (objects in combination), not a mere heap of objects.

MCQ 25

According to the picture theory, a proposition:

- A. pictures a possible situation, its names going proxy for objects B. is a mental image that resembles its object C. is a tautology of logic D. is the name of a universal

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Sense is the capacity to depict a possible arrangement; names correspond to objects and arrangement to arrangement.

MCQ 26

'Logical form' in the Tractatus is:

A. unique to spatial pictures B. the pictorial form shared by every picture and by reality, which can be shown but not said C. identical with grammatical form D. a physical property of the ink marks on the page

Correct answer: B

Explanation: A picture can depict any pictorial form but not its own logical form; logical form is the universal shared structure.

MCQ 27

A proposition differs from a mere mental image because its picturing relation is:

A. coloured like its object B. spatial in every case C. logical, not psychological D. always true

Correct answer: C

Explanation: What a proposition shares with the fact is logical form, not a mental snapshot - which is why translations picture the same situation.

MCQ 28

'Bipolarity' is the requirement that a genuine proposition must:

A. be either a tautology or a contradiction B. name at least one object C. be true in every possible case D. be capable of being true and capable of being false

Correct answer: D

Explanation: To say something is to rule something out - fixing one place in logical space and excluding the rest.

MCQ 29

In the Tractatus, a tautology is:

A. sinnlos - senseless yet well-formed, saying nothing about the world B. unsinnig - ill-formed nonsense C. false in every possible case D. the general form of the proposition

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Tautologies and contradictions carry no factual content but are perfectly legitimate; the truths of logic live here.

MCQ 30

The distinction between sinnlos and unsinnig is that:

A. both simply mean 'false' B. sinnlos is well-formed but empty (tautology/contradiction), whereas unsinnig is an ill-formed pseudo-proposition C. sinnlos means nonsense while unsinnig means sense D. they are exact synonyms

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Keep the two German terms apart: logic is sinnlos scaffolding; metaphysics stated as fact is unsinnig.

MCQ 31

For the Tractatus, ethics, aesthetics and logical form belong to what can be:

A. said in ordinary factual propositions B. proved by tautology C. shown but not said D. verified by empirical observation

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Value is transcendental - 'there can be no ethical propositions'; such matters are displayed, not stated.

MCQ 32

The 'ladder' metaphor (6.54) implies that the Tractatus's own propositions are:

A. necessary truths of reason B. empirical hypotheses open to test C. tautologies of logic D. nonsense (unsinnig) to be discarded once they have been understood

Correct answer: D

Explanation: One climbs the propositions, comes to see the world aright, and then throws the ladder away.

Remedial MCQ 33

REMEDIAL - A frequent ownership error is to treat the 2018 question comparing Berkeley with Moore and Russell as owned by this clause. Correctly, that question is:

A. primary-owned by Empiricism and used here only as a labelled cross-link B. one of the fourteen owned parts of this clause C. a Later Wittgenstein question D. owned by Indian Philosophy

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Its centre of gravity is Berkeley, so Empiricism owns it; this clause may use its Moore/Russell material but never counts it among the 14.

Remedial MCQ 34

REMEDIAL - What is the correct verdict on Russell's 'The present King of France is bald'?

A. It is meaningless B. It is false, not meaningless C. It is neither true nor false, on Russell's own view D. It is true

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The common trap is 'meaningless'; Russell's verdict is FALSE. 'Neither true nor false' is Strawson's rival, not Russell's.

Remedial MCQ 35

REMEDIAL - A tautology in the Tractatus should be classified as:

A. false B. unsinnig (nonsense) C. sinnlos (senseless but well-formed) D. part of the mystical

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Do not call a tautology 'false' or 'nonsense'; it is empty of factual content yet perfectly well-formed.

Remedial MCQ 36

REMEDIAL - Russell's atomism and the Tractatus atomism differ chiefly because:

A. they are in fact identical B. Russell's atoms are Kantian categories C. the Tractatus's atoms are physical particles D. Russell's atoms are sense-data and universals (epistemic), while the Tractatus's objects are logical simples left unexemplified

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The contrast is epistemic versus logical grounding - a key comparison, not a matter of sameness.

Remedial MCQ 37

REMEDIAL - Moore's 'Refutation of Idealism' establishes precisely that:

A. one argument for idealism (esse est percipi) fails; it does not by itself prove realism or refute Hegel B. realism is thereby directly proved C. Hegel's Absolute Idealism is refuted D. sense-data do not exist

Correct answer: A

Explanation: State the exact limits: the paper refutes one argument for idealism only; overclaiming its reach is the standard error.

Remedial MCQ 38

REMEDIAL - 'The limits of my language mean the limits of my world' (5.6) belongs to:

A. Moore's common-sense realism B. the early Wittgenstein of the Tractatus, where the self is a limit of the world C. Russell's theory of descriptions D. the later Wittgenstein's doctrine of forms of life

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Keep early and later Wittgenstein separate; this is a Tractatus thesis about the self as a limit, not an object.

Remedial MCQ 39

REMEDIAL - Kripke's later objection to the description theory of names introduces the notion of:

A. the incomplete symbol B. the sense-datum C. the rigid designator D. bipolarity

Correct answer: C

Explanation: A rigid designator picks out the same object in every possible world, challenging the view that ordinary names are disguised descriptions (a labelled later-provenance point).

Remedial MCQ 40

REMEDIAL - Proposition 7 of the Tractatus reads:

A. 'The world is all that is the case' B. 'Here is one hand' C. 'Esse est percipi' D. 'Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent'

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Proposition 7; the Pears-McGuinness translation reads 'What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence.'

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

Original Mains 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain Moore's 'paradox of analysis'. Why does it not undermine his defence of common sense? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The paradox of analysis is that a correct conceptual analysis appears *either* trivial *or* false; Moore defuses it by separating **knowing** a proposition from **analysing** it.

The paradox. Analyse "brother" as "male sibling." If analysans and analysandum have the *same* meaning, the analysis is a trivial identity ("a brother is a brother"); if it says something *new*, it seems *incorrect*. So a correct analysis looks uninformative, an informative one looks wrong.

Why common sense is safe. Moore demands correct analyses of common-sense concepts yet concedes we may not find them. But **knowing** $\neq$ **analysing**: we know truisms ("here is a hand") are true *with certainty* even when their correct analysis eludes us. Analysis works at the level of *concepts*; knowledge at the level of *truth*.

Verdict. The paradox shows analysis is not trivial word-swapping, but its sceptical bite is blocked - certainty rests on knowing, not on completed analysis.

Original Mains 2 - 15 marks

Question: Assess the claim that the early Wittgenstein's picture theory is a radicalisation of Russell's isomorphism thesis rather than a mere restatement of it. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The picture theory *inherits* Russell's isomorphism but **radicalises** it: it keeps the structural mirroring of language and world while making it the essence of *all* sense and pushing it to a limit where form can only be **shown**.

The shared core. For Russell, a true atomic proposition shares the structure of its atomic fact - names correspond to objects, arrangement to arrangement. Wittgenstein retains exactly this: a proposition is a **picture**, names go proxy for objects, and arrangement mirrors arrangement.

Three radicalisations.

1. **Generality.** Russell's isomorphism holds of *atomic* propositions; Wittgenstein makes picturing the **general form of the proposition** - every proposition is a truth-function of elementary ones, $[p\text{-bar}, xi\text{-bar}, N(xi\text{-bar})]$.
2. **Ground.** Russell's atoms are **sense-data and universals**, known by acquaintance (epistemic); Wittgenstein's "objects" are logical simples whose nature is left unspecified - the ground shifts from **epistemology to logic**.
3. **Showing.** Wittgenstein draws the consequence Russell did not: a proposition cannot depict its own **logical form**; form is **shown, not said** - yielding saying/showing and proposition 7.

Assessment. The continuity is genuine (Russell's own Introduction acknowledges it), but the differences are decisive; and the radicalised theory exposes a new fault line - the **colour-exclusion problem** (elementary propositions are not logically independent).

Verdict. "Radicalisation," not "restatement": Wittgenstein universalises isomorphism, relocates its ground to logic, and converts its unstatable residue into the doctrine of showing.

Original Mains 3 - 20 marks

Question: 'The analytic movement replaced metaphysics with the logical analysis of language.' Critically examine this claim with reference to Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein. Answer in about 300 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The slogan captures a real methodological revolution but **overstates** it: the three thinkers replaced *speculative system-building* with the analysis of language, yet each retained a substantive **metaphysics** that analysis was meant to *reveal*, not abolish.

The revolt and its method. Against Bradley's Absolute Idealism, Moore and Russell (then Wittgenstein) made **logical analysis** - exposing logical form behind grammatical form - the central task of philosophy.

Evidence for the slogan.

- Russell's **theory of descriptions** dissolves apparent commitments ("the present King of France," "the golden mountain"): grammatical form misleads, and Meinong's jungle is cleared by logic.
- **Logical constructions** replace inferred entities - "substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities."
- Wittgenstein's **saying/showing** consigns metaphysics and ethics to the unsayable; the Tractatus is a **ladder** to be discarded (prop 7).

Evidence against (metaphysics retained).

- **Logical Atomism** is itself a metaphysics - the world is a totality of **atomic facts**; analysis *reveals* ontology, it does not merely dissolve it.
- The Tractatus *opens* with ontology: "the world is the totality of facts, not of things"; objects, states of affairs. Picturing presupposes a metaphysical structure.
- **Moore** defends a robustly **realist** metaphysics (mind-independent objects) via common sense - vindicating, not abolishing, metaphysics.

Critical balance. The movement replaced one *method* (a priori system-building) with another (analysis) and disciplined ontology by logic; but "replaced metaphysics" is too strong. Later analytic philosophy confirms the point -

Strawson's descriptive metaphysics and Kripke's rigid designators revive de re necessity within the analytic method.

Verdict. Analysis of language displaced *speculative* metaphysics as the method; it did not eliminate metaphysics. Each thinker grounds his analysis in a metaphysical picture - so the movement **transformed** rather than abolished metaphysics.